Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠5

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦A

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣7

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦J

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K Q 8 6
♥ A K 10 8 2
♦ A
♣ 8 6

♠ 10 4 3
♥ Q 6
♦ K 9 6
♣ A K 7 5 2



♠ J 9 5
♥ J 4
♦ J 10 8 5 3
♣ J 10 4

♠ 7 2
♥ 9 7 5 3
♦ Q 7 4 2
♣ Q 9 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦J

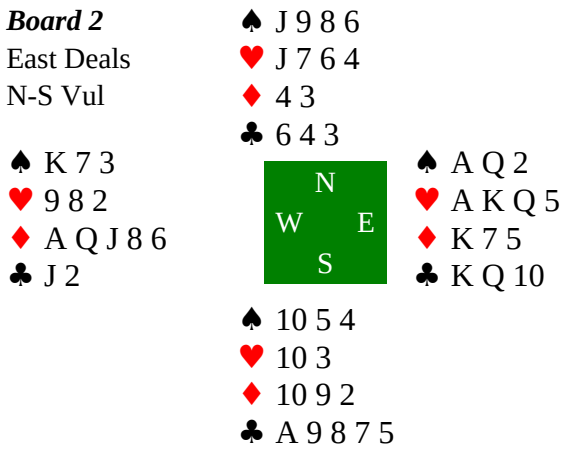
NORTH has both Majors and enough points to open 2♣. SOUTH, with 4 points, responds with a negative 2♦.

NORTH first bids her higher ranking suit, 2♠. SOUTH is too strong for second negative, he bids 2NT.

NORTH now shows her second suit, 3♥.

SOUTH is happy to bid the game in ♥s.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
3♦	Pass	3NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♠5

EAST has a balanced hand with 23 points. He opens 2♣ and expects to rebid 2NT.

WEST has 12 points so makes a positive response in her best suit. Since that suit is ♦s she must jump to the 3-level.

EAST now describes his balanced, minimum hand by bidding 3NT.

WEST bids 6NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 34 points.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A 10 9 7 2 ♥ 9 7 5 ♦ 8 5 2 ♣ A 3	
♠ 4 3 ♥ 4 3 ♦ A 9 6 4 3 ♣ 9 7 6 2		♠ Q J 8 5 ♥ 10 8 6 ♦ 10 7 ♣ 10 8 5 4
	♠ K 6 ♥ A K Q J 2 ♦ K Q J ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦A

NORTH, with 9 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

SOUTH bids her ♥s and NORTH agrees the trump suit with a 4♥ bid.

SOUTH thinks there is a slam, so she invokes Blackwood. Hearing that NORTH holds two Aces she bids 6NT. She could also have bid 6♥ but 6NT scores a little more.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 8 7 5 ♥ Q J 10 4 ♦ Q 5 4 ♣ 10 8 5	
♠ A K Q 10 3 ♥ A K 6 ♦ 8 6 ♣ A Q 4	N W E S	♠ J 4 2 ♥ 8 7 5 2 ♦ J 7 2 ♣ K 6 3
	♠ 9 6 ♥ 9 3 ♦ A K 10 9 3 ♣ J 9 7 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥Q

EAST has 5 points, so she responds 2♦ to WEST's opening 2♣ bid.

WEST bids his 5-card ♠ suit.

EAST is too good for the second negative, so she supports WEST's ♠.

WEST doesn't have enough to think about slam, so he signs off at 4♠.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K J 7 2 ♥ A 7 5 ♦ J 4 2 ♣ 6 5 3	
♠ 10 8 5 4 3 ♥ 10 8 3 ♦ K 10 ♣ 10 9 2		♠ 9 6 ♥ 9 6 4 ♦ 7 6 5 3 ♣ Q J 8 7
	♠ A Q ♥ K Q J 2 ♦ A Q 9 8 ♣ A K 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH opens 2♣ with her balanced 25 points.

NORTH has 9 points but no 5-card suit. He should make a positive response of 2NT.

SOUTH figures NORTH for 8 points and bids 6NT. If NORTH has significantly more than 8 it will be up to him to go to 7NT. But he doesn't.

Board 6
West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6 5
♥ 10 9 7 4
♦ Q 5 3
♣ Q 3

♠ K Q J 8 2
♥ A 5
♦ A K 2
♣ A K 2



♠ 7
♥ K Q J 8 3 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ 8 7 4

♠ 10 4 3
♥ 6
♦ J 10 7 4
♣ J 10 9 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♥	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♦J

WEST opens 2♣ and EAST, with 8 points should bid 2♥.

WEST should bid his ♠ suit at his second turn.

And EAST can only rebid the 6-card ♥s.

That's enough for WEST to hear. He bids 6♥, or, just as good, he might bid 6NT.